surface

(i) The outside of something.

Example

The surface of the tennis ball is furry.

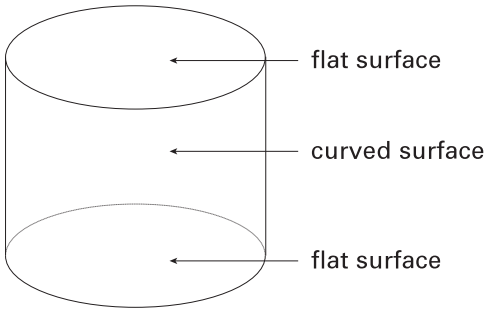
(ii) The top level of a liquid.

Example

Leaves float on the surface of a lake.

The surface of an object may be flat or curved.

Example



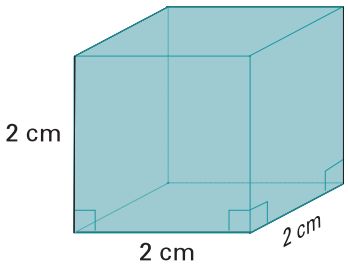
A cylinder has two flat surfaces and one curved.

See area, cylinder

surface area

The total area of the outside of a 3D shape.

Example



A cube with two centimetre sides has a surface area of

$6 \times (2 \times 2)\ \text{cm}^2 = 24\ \text{cm}^2$

See area, cube, surface

symbol

A letter, numeral or mark which represents something. We do not write a full stop after a symbol.

Examples

1 2 3 + − × ÷

= ≠ > < ≈ % □

cm kg ha m^3 ∠

a *b* x^2 $2x$

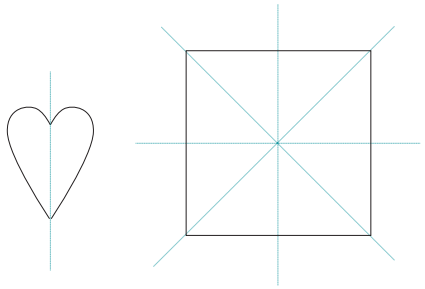
See abbreviation, place holder, pronumeral, see section Useful information pages 146–7

symmetry

A shape has symmetry or is symmetrical when one half of the shape can fit exactly over the other half.

Shapes are called symmetrical if they have one or more lines (axes) of symmetry.

Examples





See asymmetry, axis, line of symmetry, rotational symmetry

Système Internationale d'Unités

See SI